

1. SINGULAR & PLURAL

Singular (ஒருமை)

A noun referring to **one person, place, animal or thing** is called a Singular Noun.

Examples:

- a boy
- a teacher
- a book
- a child

தமிழில்:

ஒரு நபர், இடம், விலங்கு அல்லது பொருளைக் குறிக்கும் பெயர்ச்சொல் **Singular Noun** எனப்படும்.

Plural (பன்மை)

A noun referring to **more than one person, place, animal or thing** is called a Plural Noun.

Examples:

- boys
- teachers
- books
- children

தமிழில்:

ஒன்றுக்கு மேற்பட்ட நபர்கள், இடங்கள், விலங்குகள் அல்லது பொருட்களைக் குறிக்கும் பெயர்ச்சொல் **Plural Noun** எனப்படும்.

I. BASIC RULES OF PLURAL FORMATION

Rule 1: Add **-s** to most nouns

Singular	Plural
book	books
girl	girls
tree	trees
flower	flowers
chair	chairs

TNTET Tip:

80% of nouns form plural simply by adding **-s**.

Rule 2: Add -es

If a noun ends in: **s, ss, sh, ch, x, z** add **-es**

Memory Shortcut: "SS SH CH X Z → + ES"

Singular	Plural
bus	buses
class	classes
brush	brushes
church	churches
box	boxes
blitz	blitzes

II. THE "-Y" RULE

Rule 3: Consonant + y → ies

Memory Shortcut: Consonant + y → remove y + ies

Singular	Plural
baby	babies
city	cities
story	stories
puppy	puppies
century	centuries

Tamil Shortcut:

Consonant-பின் **y** வந்தால் → **y** நீக்கி **ies** சேர்க்க வேண்டும்.

Rule 4: Vowel + y → simply add s

Memory Shortcut: Vowel + y → + s

Singular	Plural
boy	boys
toy	toys
monkey	monkeys
chimney	chimneys
key	keys

III. THE "-F / -FE" RULE

Rule 5: **f / fe** → **ves**

Singular	Plural
leaf	leaves
knife	knives
wife	wives
life	lives
half	halves

Important Exceptions: These words simply take **s**

Singular	Plural
chief	chiefs
proof	proofs
handkerchief	handkerchiefs
safe	safes

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✗ chief → chieves ✓ chiefs

IV. NOUNS ENDING IN "-O": Usually add **-es**

Singular	Plural
hero	heroes
potato	potatoes
mango	mangoes

Exceptions: Some words Only add **s**

Memory Trick: **PHOTO, PIANO, RATIO, KILO** → + **S**

Singular	Plural
photo	photos
piano	pianos
ratio	ratios
kilo	kilos

V. IRREGULAR PLURALS (VERY IMPORTANT)

Vowel Change Plurals

Memory Shortcut: oo → ee

Singular	Plural
foot	feet
tooth	teeth
goose	geese

Singular	Plural
man	men
woman	women
mouse	mice
louse	lice

VI. "-EN / -REN" PLURALS

Only two important words.

Singular	Plural
ox	oxen
child	children

VII. SAME IN SINGULAR & PLURAL

TNTET Favourite Area

Singular	Plural
sheep	sheep
deer	deer
aircraft	aircraft
series	series
species	species
fish	fish
corps	corps

VIII. NOUNS USED ONLY IN PLURAL

Always take plural verbs.

Word
scissors
trousers
spectacles
thanks
police
cattle
premises
pants

Examples:

- ✓ The scissors are sharp.
- ✓ The police have arrested the thief.

IX. NOUNS USED ONLY IN SINGULAR

(Uncountable Nouns)

Word
furniture
information
advice
scenery
poetry
clothing
machinery

Common TNTET Error

- ✗ informations
- ✓ information

- ✗ advices
- ✓ advice

X. NOUNS ENDING IN -S BUT TAKING SINGULAR VERB

Subject	Verb
News	is
Mathematics	is
Economics	is
Politics	is

Examples:

✓ The news is good.

✓ Mathematics is my favourite subject.

XI. FOREIGN PLURALS (HIGHLY IMPORTANT)

Singular Ending	Plural Ending
-is	-es
-um	-a
-on	-a
-us	-i
-a	-ae
-x	-ices

-is → es

Singular	Plural
crisis	crises
thesis	theses
analysis	analyses
basis	bases

-um / -on → a

Singular	Plural
medium	media
datum	data
curriculum	curricula

criterion	criteria
phenomenon	phenomena

-us → i

Singular	Plural
syllabus	syllabi
fungus	fungi
stimulus	stimuli
alumnus	alumni

-a → ae

Singular	Plural
formula	formulae
alumna	alumnae
antenna	antennae

-x → ices

Singular	Plural
matrix	matrices
index	indices
appendix	appendices

XII. COMPOUND NOUNS: Plural is formed in the **main noun**.

Singular	Plural
daughter-in-law	daughters-in-law
son-in-law	sons-in-law
passerby	passersby
governor-general	governors-general
commander-in-chief	commanders-in-chief

XIII. EXAM TRAPS

Fish vs Fishes

Fish → general plural

Fishes → different species

Person vs People vs Peoples

Word	Meaning
person	one individual
people	many persons
peoples	different races/nations

XIV. COLLECTIVE NOUNS

Examples:

jury, committee, government, team

✓ The jury has reached its verdict.

XV. Quick Revision Table

Rule	Shortcut
crisis	crises
medium	media
syllabus	syllabi
formula	formulae
matrix	matrices
wife	wives
foot	feet
child	children

XVI. COMMON TNTET QUESTION TYPES

1. Choose the correct plural.
2. Error spotting.
3. Fill in the blanks.
4. Match singular with plural.
5. Odd one out.
6. Foreign plural identification.
7. Compound noun plural.
8. Same singular and plural nouns.

XVII. ONE-MARK QUICK REVISION

- child → children
 - ox → oxen
 - mouse → mice
 - syllabus → syllabi
 - criterion → criteria
 - sheep → sheep
 - scissors → plural only
 - advice → singular only
 - mathematics → singular verb
 - daughter-in-law → daughters-in-law
-

XVIII. VALUE-ADDED TNTET TIPS

Remember:

SS, SH, CH, X, Z → ES

Consonant + Y → IES

Vowel + Y → S

F/FE → VES

OO → EE (foot-feet)

IS → ES

UM → A

US → I

2. PUNCTUATION

Definition

Punctuation marks are symbols used to organize and clarify written language.

Importance of Punctuation

Without punctuation: "Let's eat grandma"

means something entirely different from: "Let's eat, Grandma."

I. PURPOSES OF PUNCTUATION

Punctuation helps:

1. To separate ideas in a sentence.
2. To indicate pauses while reading.
3. To express emotions and feelings.
4. To make writing clear and meaningful.

தமிழில்:

- கருத்துகளைப் பிரிக்க
- இடைநிறுத்தத்தை காட்ட
- உணர்ச்சிகளை வெளிப்படுத்த
- எழுத்தை தெளிவாக மாற்ற

II. MAJOR PUNCTUATION MARKS

Tamil Nadu textbooks introduce 11 important punctuation marks.

1. CAPITAL LETTER (A, B, C ...)

a) At the beginning of every sentence.

Example:

- ✓ She is a teacher.

b) For Proper Nouns

Examples:

- ✓ Ravi
- ✓ Chennai
- ✓ India

c) For Days, Months, Festivals and Pronoun "I"

Examples:

- ✓ Monday
- ✓ January
- ✓ Deepavali
- ✓ I am happy.

தமிழில்

ஒரு வாக்கியத்தின் தொடக்கத்திலும், தனிப்பெயர்களுக்கும் Capital Letters பயன்படுத்தப்படுகின்றன.

TNTET Shortcut

Sentence Starts → Capital Starts

2. FULL STOP (.)

Used at the end of:

- Statements
- Commands

Examples

- ✓ He is a doctor.
 - ✓ Open the window.
-

Greatest Pause

A full stop gives the **longest pause** in a sentence.

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Used in abbreviations:

Mr. **Dr.** **Prof.** **a.m.** **p.m.**

3. QUESTION MARK (?)

Use

Placed at the end of a direct question.

Examples

- ✓ Where are you going?
 - ✓ Did you complete your homework?
-

Important Rule

Direct Question → Use?

- ✓ What is your name?

Indirect Question → No?

- ✓ He asked what my name was.
-

4. EXCLAMATION MARK (!)

Used to express:

- Surprise
 - Joy
 - Sorrow
 - Anger
 - Pain
-

Usually follows Interjections

Examples:

Wow!
Oh!
Alas!
Hurrah!

Examples:

- ✓ What a beautiful flower!
- ✓ Alas! The soldier died.
- ✓ Hurrah! We won the match.

5. COMMA (,)

Uses

- a) To indicate a short pause.
- b) To separate words in a series.
- c) To address a person directly.
- d) To separate dates and places.

Examples

- ✓ Ravi, Ramesh, and Sita are friends.
- ✓ Yes, Sir, I understand.
- ✓ Chennai, 4 June 2025.

6. SEMICOLON (;)

Uses

Connects two closely related sentences.

Examples

- ✓ Work hard; you will succeed.
- ✓ He was tired; still, he continued working.

Memory Tip

Full Stop > Semicolon > Comma

(Long pause → Medium pause → Short pause)

7. COLON (:)

Uses

- a) To introduce a list.
- b) To introduce an explanation.
- c) To introduce a quotation.

Examples

- ✓ Bring the following items: pen, paper, ruler.
- ✓ He said: "Honesty is the best policy."

TNTET Shortcut

List / Explanation → Colon

8. DASH (—)

Uses

- a) Sudden break in thought.
- b) Dramatic interruption.
- c) Extra information.

Examples

- ✓ He is—believe me—the best player.
- ✓ I was about to leave—but it rained.

Note: Hyphen (-) - Joins words or parts of words. **Example:** well-known author.

TNTET Shortcut: Sudden Break → Dash

9. INVERTED COMMAS (" ")

Uses

- a) Direct Speech
- b) Quotations

Examples

- ✓ Ravi said, "I am ready."
 - ✓ The teacher asked, "Who is absent?"
-

Rules in Direct Speech

Comma comes before quotation marks.

- ✓ He said, "I am tired."
 - ✗ He said "I am tired."
-

The first word inside the quotation begins with Capital Letter.

- ✓ She said, "Come here."
-

10. APOSTROPHE (')

Uses

A. Possession

Examples:

- ✓ Ravi's book
 - ✓ The boy's pen
 - ✓ The girls' hostel
-

B. Contractions

Examples:

- It's = It is
 - Don't = Do not
 - Can't = Cannot
 - He's = He is
-

TNTET EXAM TRAP

its ≠ it's

Its - Possessive adjective

- ✓ The dog wagged its tail.

It's - Contraction of "it is"

- ✓ It's raining.
-

11. BRACKETS ()

Uses: Add extra information or explanation.

Examples

- ✓ M.S. Dhoni (former captain) retired from cricket.
- ✓ The answer (if you look carefully) is easy.

III. COMMON TNTET ERRORS

- | | | |
|----------------|--|-------------------------|
| Error 1 | ✗ Its raining. | ✓ It's raining. |
| Error 2 | ✗ He said "Come here." | ✓ He said, "Come here." |
| Error 3 | ✗ mathematics are easy. | ✓ Mathematics is easy. |
| Error 4 | ✗ wow the scenery is beautiful
beautiful. | ✓ Wow! The scenery is |

IV. QUICK REVISION TABLE

Mark	Use	Example
.	Statement	He runs.
?	Question	Where are you?
!	Emotion	Hurrah!
,	Short pause	Ram, Ravi and Raja
;	Related clauses	Work hard; succeed.
:	List	Bring: pen, pencil
—	Sudden break	He is—indeed—great
" "	Speech	She said, "Come."
'	Possession	Ravi's pen
()	Extra information	Rani (monitor)

V. ONE-MARK QUICK REVISION

- Full stop → greatest pause
- Question mark → direct question
- Exclamation mark → emotion
- Comma → short pause
- Colon → list/explanation
- Semicolon → related clauses
- Dash → sudden break
- Apostrophe → possession/omission
- Inverted commas → direct speech
- Brackets → additional information

3. GERUND & INFINITIVE

I. WHAT IS A GERUND?

A **Gerund** is the **-ing form of a verb** that functions as a **noun** in a sentence.

Definition

Gerund = Verb + ing used as a Noun

Examples:

- ✓ Swimming is good for your health.
- ✓ Reading improves knowledge.
- ✓ I enjoy singing.

தமிழில்

ஒரு வினைச்சொல்லின் **-ing** வடிவம் பெயர்ச்சொல்லாகப் பயன்பட்டால் அது **Gerund** எனப்படும்.

Functions of a Gerund

A Gerund can function as:

1. Subject of a Sentence

- ✓ Swimming is my favourite hobby.
- ✓ Reading broadens the mind.

2. Object of a Verb

- ✓ I enjoy reading novels.
- ✓ She likes painting.

3. Subject Complement

- ✓ Her hobby is dancing.
- ✓ My passion is teaching.

4. After a Preposition

- ✓ He is interested in learning English.
- ✓ She is fond of singing.

TNTET Shortcut

Verb + ing acting as Noun = Gerund

II. WHAT IS AN INFINITIVE?

An **Infinitive** is the base form of a verb usually preceded by **to**.

Definition

Infinitive = To + V₁

Examples:

- ✓ To read
- ✓ To sing
- ✓ To dance

தமிழில்

'**To + Verb**' வடிவில் வரும் வினைச்சொல் **Infinitive** எனப்படும்.

Functions of an Infinitive

An infinitive may act as:

1. Noun

- ✓ **To err** is human.
- ✓ She likes **to dance**.

2. Adjective

- ✓ This is the best place **to study**. (= modifies "place")

3. Adverb

- ✓ He came **to meet** me. (Shows purpose)

TNTET Shortcut

To + Verb = Infinitive

III. TYPES OF INFINITIVES

1. Full Infinitive

Structure: **To + V₁**

Examples:

- ✓ to write
- ✓ to play
- ✓ to study

2. Bare Infinitive

Structure: **Verb without "to"**

Examples:

- ✓ He made me cry.
- ✓ Let him go.
- ✓ I saw him leave.

TNTET Shortcut

Modal Verbs + Bare Infinitive

can go should study must work may come

Common verbs followed by a bare infinitive:

- **can, could, may, might, must, shall, should, will, would**
- **let, make, help** (sometimes)

IV. GERUND vs PRESENT PARTICIPLE

Many people confuse these forms.

Gerund: Functions as **a noun**.

- ✓ **Swimming** is good exercise. (Subject)

Present Participle: Functions as **an adjective**.

- ✓ The **swimming boy** is my brother. (adjective)

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Identify whether "-ing" is a Gerund or Participle.

V. VERBS FOLLOWED BY GERUNDS

Some verbs are always followed by Gerunds.

Verb	Example
admit	He admitted stealing money.
avoid	Avoid wasting time.
enjoy	I enjoy reading books.
consider	She considered joining the course.
deny	He denied taking the money.
finish	She finished writing the letter.
keep	Keep smiling.
mind	Do you mind opening the window?
miss	I miss seeing my friends.
practise	Practise speaking English.
suggest	He suggested going home.

VI. VERBS FOLLOWED BY INFINITIVES

Some verbs are always followed by infinitives.

Verb	Example
agree	They agreed to help us.
decide	He decided to join us.
expect	We expect to win.
hope	She hopes to succeed.
learn	I learnt to swim.
need	I need to study.
plan	They planned to travel.
promise	He promised to come.
refuse	She refused to obey.
want	I want to buy a car.

wish	I wish to meet him.
------	---------------------

VII. VERBS FOLLOWED BY BOTH GERUND & INFINITIVE

Certain verbs can take both forms. However, the meaning changes.

1. REMEMBER

Gerund

- ✓ I remember meeting him. (*= memory of a past event*)

Infinitive

- ✓ Remember to post the letter. (*= future duty*)

2. FORGET

- ✓ I forgot locking the door. (*past memory*)

- ✓ I forgot to lock the door. (*failed to do*)

3. STOP

Gerund

- ✓ He stopped smoking. (*= gave up the habit*)

Infinitive

- ✓ He stopped to smoke. (*= stopped in order to smoke*)

4. TRY

Gerund

- ✓ Try reading this book. (*experiment*)

Infinitive

- ✓ Try to solve the problem. (*make an effort*)

5. REGRET

- ✓ I regret informing you. (*action already done*)

- ✓ I regret to inform you. (*formal announcement*)

VIII. GERUND AFTER PREPOSITIONS

Golden Rule: After a Preposition → Always use Gerund

Examples:

- ✓ He is fond **of** reading.
- ✓ She is good **at** dancing.
- ✓ He was punished **for** cheating.
- ✓ Thank you **for** helping me.

Common Prepositions

About, for, of, in, on, at, after, before, without & by

IX. INFINITIVE TO SHOW PURPOSE

Infinitives often express purpose or intention.

Examples:

- ✓ She went **to buy** vegetables.

- ✓ I came here **to help** you.
- ✓ He works hard **to succeed**.

X. BARE INFINITIVE

Bare infinitives are used after:

1. Modal Verbs

can
could
may
might
must
shall
should
will
would

Examples:

- ✓ You should work hard.
- ✓ He can swim.

2. Causative Verbs (*Make others do things*)

make
let
have
help
get

Examples:

- ✓ The teacher made me write.
- ✓ Let him go.

3. Verbs of Perception (*Perceiving things through senses*)

see
hear
watch
feel
notice
observe
smell

Examples:

- ✓ I saw him enter the room.
- ✓ We heard her sing.

XI. COMMON TNTET QUESTION TYPES

1. Fill in the blanks.
2. Error spotting.
3. Choose the correct form.
4. Identify Gerund/Infinitive.

5. Rewrite sentences.
6. Find meaning changes.

XII. COMMON TNTET ERRORS

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--|
| ✗ I enjoy to read books. | ✓ I enjoy reading books. |
| ✗ He suggested to go home. | ✓ He suggested going home. |
| ✗ He refused helping me. | ✓ He refused to help me. |
| ✗ She is interested to learn English. | ✓ She is interested in learning English. |

XIII. QUICK REVISION TABLE

Structure	Example
Gerund	Reading is useful.
Infinitive	To read is useful.
Preposition + Gerund	interested in learning
Purpose	came to help
Modal + Bare Infinitive	can swim
Stop + Gerund	quit habit
Stop + Infinitive	purpose

XIV. ONE-MARK QUICK REVISION

- Gerund = Verb + ing used as noun
- Infinitive = To + Verb
- After prepositions → Gerund
- Modals → Bare Infinitive
- Enjoy → Gerund
- Decide → Infinitive
- Stop + Ving = Quit
- Stop + To V = Purpose

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